

Philipp Hilbert. *Head of Product for AI-native fintech.*

Positioning, 13 years shipping B2B SaaS products in regulated industries, now focused on AI-native platforms for SME financial services.

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§ WHY DAIRA

You are building an AI-native accounting firm on top of a proprietary platform, which means the product problems are harder than typical SaaS: the workflows are regulated, the users are time-poor business owners, and the AI agents have to be right, not just helpful. The job description names first-round UAT acceptance as a success metric, which tells me you care about requirements quality, not just shipping speed. I have spent two years on exactly that problem in regulated environments, defence AI at Rohde & Schwarz and labour-market analytics at the Bundesagentur für Arbeit.

That combination of AI-native product work and regulated-domain rigour is where I do my best work.

§ AI-NATIVE STACK

Daily tools, not buzzwords.

- **Claude Code**, in-repo specs and edge-case generation
- **GitHub Copilot**, assisted development
- **Cursor**, IDE-level AI pair programming
- **Lovable**, rapid front-end prototyping
- **Framer**, design-heavy iteration
- **n8n**, agentic workflow automation
- **GPT**, research and structured drafting
- **Gamma.app**, stakeholder presentations

§ TECHNICAL ENVIRONMENT

Shipped with, not just listed.

Python, Kotlin (Spring Boot), PostgreSQL, MongoDB, REST APIs, Kafka, Kubernetes, Docker, ArgoCD, GitOps, CI/CD with Jenkins and GitLab, Dagster, dbt, Jira, Confluence, Figma, Miro, Azure DevOps.

§ SIDE PROJECT

CONSTRUCT8 [GITHUB.COM/HILBERTP](https://github.com/HilbertP) →

Two-sided B2B staffing marketplace, built solo from zero.

- Matches construction firms with workers, cutting out the headhunter with an anonymity-until-payment model that protects both sides until commitment.
 - WhatsApp and Telegram as the product surface, LLM agents across the full funnel so one person runs day-to-day operations.
 - Funnel and conversion analysis in SQL; full product lifecycle owned by one person.
 - Demonstrates exactly the zero-to-one, AI-native build approach Daira is hiring for.
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§ HOW I WOULD WORK AT DAIRA

First weeks, concrete.

WEEK 1

Listen, map, find the gaps.

Shadow the accountants and client success team through real OneFinance workflows, map where the AI agents hand off to humans, and identify where first-round UAT failures are actually originating.

WEEK 2

Slice the backlog.

Sit with the CPTO and engineering leads to score the existing backlog against business impact and tech effort, and establish the two-sprint readiness buffer the job description calls for.

WEEK 3+

Ship and close loops.

Run the first full sprint planning cycle, define the post-launch review cadence for each feature, and set up the adoption tracking so success metrics are agreed before anything goes to UAT.

I COVER LETTER

Dear Daira team,

I am applying for the Head of Product role. Daira is building something that most fintech companies only talk about: an AI-native service where the agents are doing real compliance work, not just populating form fields. That is a harder product problem than it looks, and it is the kind I want to work on.

My background fits this role directly. I have 13 years in B2B SaaS product management across regulated industries, insurance, public-sector analytics, defence AI, healthcare, and payments. I know what it takes to write requirements that survive first-round UAT, to keep a backlog two sprints ahead of the team, and to align engineers, business stakeholders, and end users around a shared definition of done. At Rohde & Schwarz I owned the AI and data platform for the FCAS programme, leading 15+ engineers and data scientists through Scrum while reducing rollout time from days to 30 minutes via GitOps. At CLINET Platforms I cut an undeliverable roadmap to its top 10% and watched user acceptance rise more than fivefold. Both outcomes came from the same discipline: agree on what success looks like before you build, then check whether it happened.

I have also built AI-native products myself. I use Claude Code, GitHub Copilot, Cursor, and Lovable daily, not as productivity tricks, but to prototype, spec, and pressure-test ideas before they reach engineering. I built construct8, a two-sided B2B marketplace, alone: LLM agents across the funnel, SQL-based conversion analysis, WhatsApp and Telegram as the product surface. I understand what agentic workflows actually cost to maintain, where they break, and how to design human-in-the-loop fallbacks that keep the product trustworthy.

The UAE SME market is a specific fit for me. I am actively targeting Dubai and willing to relocate, which means I would be on-site from day one, not adjusting from a different timezone. The fintech and SaaS regulatory context in the GCC is different from the EU, and I would spend the first weeks learning it properly. What I bring is the product discipline and AI-native execution capability that lets a small team ship a roadmap that holds together under scrutiny.

I would welcome a conversation about what the first quarter looks like and where you see the biggest product risk right now.

Best regards, *Philipp Hilbert*

II CURRICULUM VITAE

§ PROFILE

Product manager and product owner with 13 years of product ownership in regulated industries, including fintech, insurance, B2B SaaS, defence AI and public-sector analytics. I run continuous discovery, turn strategy and user needs into user stories and a prioritised roadmap, and lead cross-functional teams through agile sprint planning and delivery (Scrum, Kanban, SAFe). I have built AI and LLM-based products in production and prototyped with AI-native tooling daily.

§ HOW I WORK

- I leave my ego at home. I want to drive the decision, not to have the last word.
 - On a new product I spend a little to learn before spending a lot to build. Cheap experiments make expensive decisions safe(r).
 - Outcome over output. Producing something is not the achievement; it also has to fit a market, so I agree what would count as success before we build and check afterwards whether it happened.
 - I keep the whole value chain in view, not just the backlog. Defect-to-fix time is a product metric; architects and DevOps engineers build that chain, my job is to steer it into the right lanes.
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§ WORK EXPERIENCE

PRODUCT MANAGER, ROHDE & SCHWARZ, MUNICH / REMOTE |
07/2024-05/2025

Defence and aerospace. Internal AI and data platform for the FCAS European programme.

- Led AI and data platform delivery for the FCAS programme: 15+ engineers and data scientists through Scrum in Jira and Confluence, GitOps rollout with ArgoCD reducing deployment time from days to 30 minutes.
- Redirected product strategy based on user workflow analysis, increasing pipeline runs by 200% by prioritising developer-code-first over UI-led design.

PRODUCT MANAGER, BUNDESAGENTUR FÜR ARBEIT, NUREMBERG /
REMOTE | 05/2023-07/2024

Public sector. National labour-market analytics platform for policymakers and researchers.

- Introduced Dagster and dbt to the ETL pipeline, saving almost 75% of time per data update; migrated a bare-metal system fully into containers.
- Integrated test automation into the Jenkins CI/CD pipeline and freed several QA hours every week.

PRODUCT OWNER, CLINET PLATFORMS, BERLIN | 01/2023-07/2023

Healthcare. Mobile patient app for iOS and Android, piloted in hospitals.

- Cut an undeliverable roadmap to the top 10% of features against agreed success measures: user acceptance rose more than fivefold.
- Implemented the CGM interface into hospital KIS workflows: digital anamnesis time dropped from 30 minutes to 5.

PRODUCT MANAGER, EMIL GROUP, BERLIN | 04/2022-12/2022

Insurance. B2B SaaS platform for insurers, reinsurers, brokers and underwriters.

- Restructured an 18-person delivery organisation into three lean teams: attrition fell from near-total exodus to a single departure.
- Shipped the Claims Center from concept to production; cut time-to-market for a new insurance product from months to under a week.

PRODUCT OWNER INTEGRATION TEAM, SCHEIDT & BACHMANN,
MÖNCHENGLADBACH | 09/2021-03/2022

Retail and payments. POS and forecourt systems in a full SAFe setup with agile release trains and PI planning.

- Moved research results into production across a matrix organisation.

PRODUCT OWNER (INTERIM), BUNDESDRUCKEREI, BERLIN |
03/2021-06/2021

- Government secure data platform. Data structures and identity management for the Robert Koch Institute programmes DIM and DESH.

PRODUCT OWNER (PROXY), AOK ITSCARE, FRANKFURT | 03/2019-05/2020

Health insurance. B2B procurement webshop.

- Migrated a legacy system to Shopware for three AOK insurers and roughly 20,000 employees; still in production. Backlog refinement, user stories and acceptance criteria in Jira.

§ FOUNDER TRACK

FOUNDER AND PRODUCT MANAGER, CONSTRUCT8, LIMASSOL | 12/2025-PRESENT

Construction staffing. Two-sided B2B marketplace matching firms with workers.

- Built zero to one alone: LLM agents across the funnel, WhatsApp and Telegram as the product surface, anonymity-until-payment model, funnel and conversion analysis in SQL.

CO-FOUNDER AND PRODUCT OWNER, QCRYPT AG, BERLIN | 01/2016-12/2021

IT security. Integrated hardware and software for quantum-secure encryption.

- Shipped a three-layer product that installs in under two minutes to meet enterprise buyer constraints; later Chair of the board.

FOUNDER AND CFO, KVITT PAYMENT SOLUTIONS, BERLIN | 02/2013-11/2018

Fintech. Mobile group-based P2P payments.

- Built from zero and taken to acquisition: acquired and operated by Sparkasse inside the girocard ecosystem.

§ SKILLS

AI Products and Tooling: LLM agents, agentic workflows, prompt and context engineering, evaluation loops, human-in-the-loop design, AI governance, EU AI Act, Explainable AI (XAI); Claude Code, GitHub Copilot, Cursor, Lovable, n8n.

Product Management: continuous discovery, product vision and roadmap, prioritisation, MVP definition, PoC, A/B testing, user research and interviews, prototyping, product lifecycle management, go-to-market support.

Product Ownership: requirements engineering, user stories, acceptance criteria, definition of done, epics, backlog refinement, sprint planning, UAT (user acceptance testing), Jira, Confluence, Figma, Miro.

Agile and Scaled Delivery: Agile, Scrum, Kanban, SAFe (Scaled Agile Framework), ART, PI planning.

Fintech and SaaS Domains: B2B SaaS, fintech, P2P payments, PSP integration, girocard ecosystem, insurance SaaS, regulated product delivery.

Analytics and Data: funnel and churn analysis, KPI definition, ETL, Dagster, dbt, PostgreSQL, Matomo, MicroStrategy.

Technical Environments Owned: Kubernetes, Docker, ArgoCD, GitOps, CI/CD, Jenkins, GitLab, Azure DevOps, REST APIs, Python, Kotlin, SQL, PostgreSQL, MongoDB, Kafka.

Governance and Business: GDPR, Deputy IT Security Officer, identity management, budget ownership and financial planning, ROI reasoning.

§ EDUCATION

DIPLOM-WIRTSCHAFTSINGENIEUR (INDUSTRIAL ENGINEERING AND MANAGEMENT, EQUIVALENT TO A MASTER'S DEGREE), TECHNISCHE UNIVERSITÄT BERLIN (TU BERLIN), GERMANY | 10/2006-09/2014

- Specialisation: Logistics. Thesis with Siemens AG Energy Service on balancing-power market profitability.

§ LANGUAGES

German (native speaker, C2) · English (C2, business and technical fluency)

LinkedIn · GitHub · www.true-north.berlin · YouTube (EN sample)